

PRESIDENT WILSON'S MESSAGE

National Preparedness Main Theme of Head of Nation. Submits Definite Plan to Increase Present Standing Force of Regulars and For Four Hundred Thousand Citizen Soldiers Raised in Increments of One Hundred and Thirty-three Thousand.

FOLLOWING is the message of President Wilson delivered at a joint session of the senate and house at the beginning of the Sixty-fourth congress:

Gentlemen of the Congress—Since I last had the privilege of addressing you on the state of the Union the war of nations on the other side of the sea, which had then only begun to disclose its portentous proportions, has extended its threatening and sinister scope until it has swept within its flame some portion of every quarter of the globe, not excepting our own hemisphere, has altered the whole face of international affairs, and now presents a prospect of reorganization and reconstruction such as statesmen and peoples have never been called upon to attempt before.

The president tells how this country practiced neutrality and declares that he hopes that when the time comes for readjustment and recuperation this country will be of infinite service. Referring to Central and South American problems, the president declares that we should retain unimpaired the spirit which has inspired us throughout the whole life of our government and which was so frankly put into words by President Monroe.

We have been put to the test in the case of Mexico, and we have stood the test. Whether we have benefited Mexico by the course we have pursued remains to be seen. Her fortunes are in her own hands. But we have at least proved that we will not take advantage of her in her distress and under take to impose upon her an order and government of our own choosing. Liberty is often a fierce and intractable thing, to which no bounds can be set and to which no bounds of a few men's choosing ought ever to be set.

Every American who has drunk at the true fountains of principle and tradition must subscribe without reservation to the high doctrine of the Virginia bill of rights, which in the great days in which our government was set up was everywhere among us accepted as the creed of free men. That doctrine is, "That government is or ought to be instituted for the common benefit, protection and security of the people, nation or community; that of all the various modes and forms of government, that is the best which is capable of producing the greatest degree of happiness and safety, and is most effectually secured against the danger of maladministration, and that when any government shall be found inadequate or contrary to these purposes a majority of the community hath an undoubted, inalienable and indefeasible right to reform, alter or abolish it in such manner as shall be judged most conducive to the public weal." We have unhesitatingly applied that heroic principle to the case of Mexico and now hopefully await the rebirth of the troubled republic, which had so much of which to purge itself and so little sympathy from any outside quarter of the radical but necessary process. We will aid and befriend Mexico; but we will not interfere, and our course with regard to her ought to be sufficient proof to all America that we seek no political suzerainty or selfish control.

PAN-AMERICANISM HAS NONE OF EMPIRE'S SPIRIT.

Economic Adjustments Inevitable With the Next Generation.

The moral is that the states of America are not hostile rivals, but co-operating friends, and that their growing sense of community of interest, alike in matters political and in matters economic, is likely to give them a new significance as factors in international affairs and in the political history of the world. It presents them as in a very deep and true sense a unit in world affairs, spiritual partners, standing together because thinking together, quick with common sympathies and common ideals. Separated, they are subject to all the cross currents of the confused politics of a world of hostilities; united in spirit and purpose, they cannot be disappointed of their peaceful destiny.

This is pan-Americanism. It has none of the spirit of empire in it. It is the embodiment, the effectual embodiment, of the spirit of law and independence and liberty and mutual service.

The president calls attention to the meeting in Washington recently of representatives of the pan-American republics and says that economic adjustment is inevitable in the next generation.

No one who really comprehends the spirit of the great people for whom we are appointed to speak can fail to perceive that their passion is for peace, their genius best displayed in the practice of the arts of peace. Great democracies are not belligerent. They do not seek or desire war. Their thought is



Photo by American Press Association.
PRESIDENT WILSON'S LATEST PICTURE.
(From snapshot taken on Nov. 26.)

of individual liberty and of the free labor that supports life and the unencumbered thought that quickens it. Conquest and dominion are not in our reckoning or agreeable to our principles. But just because we demand unimpaired development and the undisturbed government of our own lives upon our own principles of right and liberty, we resent, from whatever quarter it may come, the aggression we ourselves will not practice. We insist upon security in prosecuting our self-chosen lines of national development. We do more than that. We demand it also for others. We do not confine our enthusiasm for individual liberty and free national development to the incidents and movements of affairs which affect only ourselves. We feel it where ever there is a people that tries to walk in these difficult paths of independence and right. From the first we have made common cause with all partisans of liberty on this side the sea and have deemed it as important that our neighbors should be free from all outside domination as that we ourselves should be; have set America aside as a whole for the uses of independent nations and political freedom.

Out of such thoughts grow all our policies. We regard war merely as a means of asserting the rights of a people against aggression. And we are as fiercely jealous of coercive or dictatorial power within our own nation as of aggression from without. We will not maintain a standing army except for uses which are as necessary in times of peace as in times of war.

SUGGESTS BROAD PLAN FOR NATIONAL DEFENSE.

Increase Standing Regular Force—Four Hundred Thousand Citizen Soldiers.

But war has never been a mere matter of men and guns. It is a thing of discipline, of might. If our citizens are ever to fight effectively upon a sudden summons, they must know how modern fighting is done, and what to do when the summons comes to render themselves immediately available and immediately effective. And the government must be their servant in this matter, must supply them with the training they need to take care of themselves and of it. The military arm of their government, which they will not allow to direct them, they may properly use to serve them and make their independence secure, and not their own independence merely, but the rights also of those with whom they have made common cause, should they also be put in jeopardy. They must be fitted to play the great role in the world, and particularly in this hemisphere, for which they are qualified by principle and by chastened ambition to play.

It is with these ideals in mind that the plans of the department of war for more adequate national defense were conceived which will be laid before you, and which I urge you to sanction and put into effect as soon as they can be properly scrutinized and discussed. They seem to me the essential first steps, and they seem to me for the present sufficient.

They contemplate an increase of the standing force of the regular army from its present strength of 5,023 officers and 102,085 enlisted men, or 141,843 all told, all services, rank and file, by the addition of fifty-two companies of coast artillery, fifteen companies of engineers, ten regiments of infantry, four regiments of field artillery and four aero squadrons, besides 750 officers required for a great variety of extra service, especially the all important duty of training the citizen force of which I shall presently speak, 792 non-commissioned officers for service in drill, recruiting and the like and the necessary quota of enlisted men for the quartermaster corps, the hospital corps, the ordnance department and other similar auxiliary services. These

Declares That if Full Navy Program is Carried Out We Will Have a Fleet For Defense That Will Be "Fitted to Our Needs and Worthy of Our Traditions." Greatest Danger to Country Comes From Within Our Borders.

are the additions necessary to render the army adequate for its present duties, duties which it has to perform not only upon our own continental coasts and borders and at our interior army posts, but also in the Philippines, in the Hawaiian Islands, at the isthmus and in Porto Rico.

By way of making the country ready to assert some part of its real power promptly and upon a larger scale should occasion arise the plan also contemplates supplementing the army by a force of 400,000 disciplined citizens, raised in increments of 133,000 a year throughout a period of three years. This it is proposed to do by a process of enlistment under which the serviceable men of the country would be asked to bind themselves to serve with the colors for purposes of training for short periods throughout three years and to come to the colors at call at any time throughout an additional "furlough" period of three years. This force of 400,000 men would be provided with personal accoutrements as fast as enlisted and their equipment for the field made ready to be supplied at any time. They would be assembled for training at stated intervals at convenient places in association with suitable units of the regular army. Their period of annual training would not necessarily exceed two months in the year.

The president says it is up to the patriotic young men of the country to respond to this call.

COMPREHENSIVE PLAN FOR GREATER NAVY.

Always Looked to It as Our First and Chief Line of Defense.

The program which will be laid before you by the secretary of the navy is similarly conceived. It involves only a shortening of the time within which plans long matured shall be carried out, but it does make definite and explicit a program which has heretofore been implicit, held in the minds of the committees on naval affairs and disclosed in the debates of the two houses, but nowhere formulated or formally adopted. It seems to me very clear that it will be to the advantage of the country for the congress to adopt a comprehensive plan for putting the navy upon a final footing of strength and efficiency and to press that plan to completion within the next five years. We have always looked to the navy of the country as our first and chief line of defense; we have always seen it to be our manifest course of prudence to be strong on the seas. Year by year we have been creating a navy which now ranks very high in deed among the navies of the maritime nations. We should now definitely determine how we shall complete what we have begun and how soon.

The program to be laid before you contemplates the construction within five years of ten battleships, six battle cruisers, ten scout cruisers, fifty destroyers, fifteen fleet submarines, eighty-five coast submarines, four gunboats, one hospital ship, two ammunition ships, two fuel oil ships and one repair ship. It is proposed that this number we shall the first year provide for the construction of two battleships, two battle cruisers, three scout cruisers, fifteen destroyers, five fleet submarines, twenty-five coast submarines, two gunboats and one hospital ship; the second year two battleships, one scout cruiser, ten destroyers, four fleet submarines, fifteen coast submarines, one gunboat and one fuel oil ship; the third year two battleships, one battle cruiser, two scout cruisers, five destroyers, two fleet submarines and fifteen coast submarines; the fourth year two battleships, two battle cruisers, two scout cruisers, ten destroyers, two fleet submarines, fifteen coast submarines, one ammunition ship and one fuel oil ship, and the fifth year two battleships, one battle cruiser, two scout cruisers, ten destroyers, two fleet submarines, fifteen coast submarines, one gunboat, one ammunition ship and one repair ship.

The secretary of the navy is asking also for the immediate addition to the personnel of the navy of 7,500 sailors, 2,500 apprentice seamen and 1,500 marines. This increase would be sufficient to care for the ships which are to be completed within the fiscal year 1917 and also for the number of men which must be put in training to man the ships which will be completed early in 1918. It is also necessary that the number of midshipmen at the Naval academy at Annapolis should be increased by at least 300 in order that the force of officers should be more rapidly added to, and authority is asked to appoint, for engineering duties only, approved graduates of engineering colleges, and for service in the aviation corps a certain number of men taken from civil life.

In this full program should be carried out we should have built or building in 1921, according to the estimates of survival and standards of classification followed by the general board of the

(Continued on Page 8)

JOHN STARK EXPLAINS

A short time ago some gentle critic casually observed that while I had pointed out many wrongs in the body politic I had never proposed a "remedy." Strange that I had never noticed that lapse. Come to think it over the point seems well taken.

This brought up a long list of suggestions I have made during my desultory contributions and for this person's benefit I will recall a few of them. Among other things I suggested the confiscation of all industrial plants such as factories, mines, the transportation systems, etc., also land held for speculative purposes or exploitation.

To bring this about I advocated the working class to take possession of the government, repudiate all public debts including those held against these industries which are quasi-public debts. Abolish such political government as it exists to day and give these hangers on something useful to occupy them. Cart our stupid law books to the furnace and give the lawyers a chance to grub out some of the logged-off land where they could grow their own oats.

Coming closer home I suggested the building of a large meeting place where any and all kinds of religion could be taught by "experts" in that line—FREE. That would release a full baker's dozen preachers to go out cutting cordwood for their salvation. Besides that I also prophesied our farmers should have credit (money) from the federal government at cost.

In a dim way I realize I did not offer any solution for the stupendous problem whether wrist watches should be worn on the front leg or the hind. Candidly, the task was too great for one living in the uncult. Such momentous questions must have specially adapted minds, such as continually dwell in the national capitol. My whole mind is taken up with those trivial matters effecting flap-jacks and the lubricants necessary for skidding them forward. Of course, I know in that dumb way we of the lower orders know anything, that these suggestions are so prosaic that great intellects resort to yawning in order to escape making some ugly remarks when one of us grimy-handed sons of the soil talk about such common place affairs, but we just can't help it. We live, or exist, so close to the earth that we just can't rise above our surroundings.

Perhaps my critic expected me to work out a long, elaborate program for all men for all time to follow. That seems the usual way for the "reformers" and "philosophers" to do. I believe some such plan was evolved for one of the American colonies.

The designer, a great English philosopher, laid out all the details to govern the colony and sealed them, the same not to be opened till they reached mid-ocean. The ship did not go down with this precious burden but I believe this masterpiece became a burden soon after landing in the new world.

You will see the same effort made on all sides. Take the farm credit system. Great tables of amortization schemes, bonds, coupons and what not with endless miles of red tape. Elaborate interest tables, banks bonding companies, gambling on God's footstool. Debts without end. What is all this humbug for? Can we not delegate our government to furnish credit at cost to be repaid at the convenience of the borrower? If not, why not?

JOHN F. STARK.

"SPEEDING UP" PAYS

Wisconsin Dairyman Finds Profits in Modern Methods

The size of a farm business is not necessarily measured or limited by the number of acres in a farm. One of the field men of the department, engaged in farm-survey work, reported the case of a Wisconsin farmer, so situated as to make it impossible for him to buy or rent more land, who solved the problem of small acreage by "speeding up" the 80 acres that he had.

This farmer's first move was to dispose of his scrub cows and to replace them with grades and purebreds; next, without great expense, he improved the sanitary condition of his barns. He established a cropping system based on corn and alfalfa, choosing the latter rather than clover because on his farm it produces at least 50 percent more feed per acre than does clover, and is much more dependable.

Pastures have now entirely disappeared from this farm, because its owner has demonstrated that 1 acre of corn and 1 of alfalfa together furnish him with more feed than do 5 acres of pasture. His improved, well-fed herd, housed in a clean, well-lighted, and thoroughly ventilated barn, is yielding him more than double the milk he formerly got from his scrub herd. Furthermore, the quality of the milk has improved, and he demands and gets the price of a first-class article.

The largely increased net income which this farmer now receives from the sale of milk and of purebred cattle is based on the comparatively small changes in his type of farming, which have augmented his business without entailing any increase in the size of his farm.

Strong and Well As Ever
Fred Smith, 325 Main St., Green Bay, Wis., says: "I suffered a long time with a very weak back. Foley Kidney Pills completely relieved me of all soreness and pain and I now am as strong and well as ever." Winter aggravates symptoms of kidney trouble; cold weather makes aching joints, sore muscles, and irregular bladder action more unbearable. Foley Kidney Pills help the kidneys eliminate pain-causing poisons.—Jones Drug Co.

Did you ever give the Courier a trial on your stationery? You will find that they have the most up-to-date faces of type and are right there with the punch in getting up a suitable design that will please you—and please others.

HOW TO WASH

Agricultural College Experts Tell Way to Handle Laundry

A "short method" of laundry that materially lessens the labor of laundering by hand is based on the principle of boiling first and rubbing only what is then required. The method is suggested as having many advantages but it does not remove odors completely or sterilize the clothes. The plan is as follows:

Soak all except the colored clothes and stockings over night. Put water containing one cup soap and two table spoonfuls kerosene in boiler and boil clothes in solution for half hour, or less if not badly soiled. Take from boiler and rub where necessary. Rinse blue starch and hang.

Hang with the wind, to avoid strain. Fasten with enough pins to prevent stretching out of shape.

Hang lengthwise of the fabric when possible.

Put colored clothes and woollens in shade.

Group clothing of the same kind when possible.

Pillow cases, skirts and underclothing, hang wrong side out.

Remove from line, sprinkle starched clothes, and fold all in basket. Articles that must be ironed at once should be wrapped tightly in a towel, or cloth, that has been dipped into warm water and wrung out.

This description is taken from the newly published O. A. C. bulletin on "Methods of Cleaning," copies of which may be had on application.

THE HOBSON PLAN

Is It Prohibition or Publicity that "Kiss King" Is Seeking

Richmond Pearson Hobson, who was recently in the county seat on a speaking tour, has ambitious plans. The National Monthly recently gave the inside of some of Hobson's plans, and reprinted a letter which he sent all editors in the United States. The letter follows:

I am sending you under a separate cover a copy of my recent Prohibition speech, and also, for your information, a copy of a standard individual letter to accompany same.

Before my right to use the Government frank expires next Fall, I wish to send the speech and the letter individually into all the homes of America.

While my part of the cost is but a fraction of the total cost to the Government, yet covering the whole country, it will amount to about \$150,000.

Would you, through your columns, help to raise the fund? In order to facilitate your action, I am enclosing a draft for a news article which can be used as the basis for editorials.

Faithfully yours,
(Signed) R. P. HOBSON.

In an article, which was sent with the letter, one paragraph reads:

"This plan has the double advantage of utilizing the authority and prestige of the National Government, which is so impressive with the casual citizen, especially if he has come from a foreign country, and also of utilizing the public printing plant and the Government's frank, saving the bulk of the cost."

It strikes us that Mr. Hobson,

formerly famed as being the most kissed man in the world, is undertaking the expenditure of considerable government funds in order to get his speech scattered broadcast. It would be better, and more in keeping with Mr. Hobson's duty to the taxpayers of the United States, it strikes us, to have him persuade some of his back-

have him persuade some of his back-

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| 10c BOX for three fine sheer Lawn Handkerchiefs in embroidered-corner styles; they come in a fancy holiday box. | 95c BOX for six extra fine Handkerchiefs, shown in embroidered patterns in white or pastel shades—\$1.25 and \$1.50 values at 95c a box. |

Dozens of other equally as attractive offerings not mentioned here for lack of space.

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